

Rulebook

2–5 players

The paintball competition is fierce. Paint is flying everywhere. Your goal is simple: stay as clean as you can and don’t get splat.

In Don't Get Splat! you draft paint cards and add them to your own four colour stacks. Every card you play is paint on you, but also an ability that can manipulate the playing field.

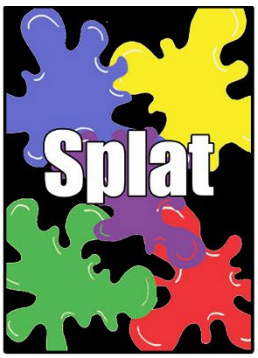
The player with the lowest score after 3 rounds wins.

At the end of each round you score the value of every face-up card in your stacks, plus penalty points for leading that round's two Goal cards. Points pile up across rounds, so keep your paint low, dodge the Goals, and push the mess onto everyone else.

Components



73 Paint Cards



32 Splat Cards



8 Big Splat Cards



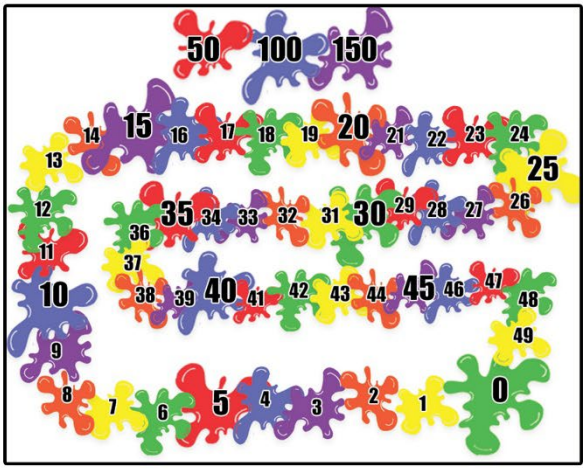
15 Mud Cards



7 Round Goal cards



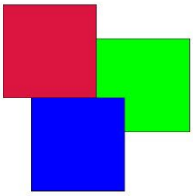
5 Keep Cards



Scoreboard



Pass Token



10 player trackers



20 colour cards

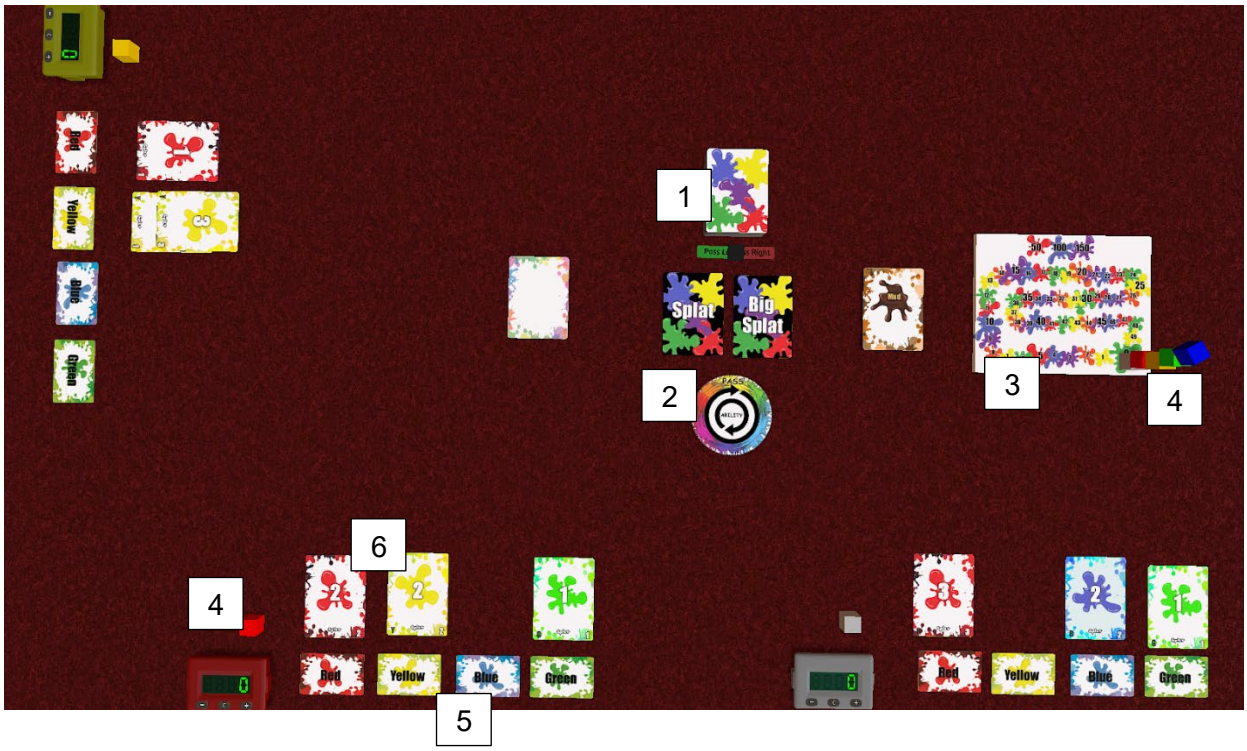
Setup

Central Area

1. Create a face-down deck for each of the following card types – Paint, Splat, Big Splat, Mud and Round Goals. Shuffle each individually and place in the middle of the table so that everyone can grab from them.
2. Place the Pass Token in the middle of the table and flip it random side up.
3. Place the scoreboard in the middle of the table.

Players

4. Each player chooses a colour. They place one cube of that colour in front of them and the other on the 0 space on the scoreboard.
5. Each player gains 4 colour cards (one of each colour) and places them in a horizontal row in front of them.
6. Each player draws 3 Splat cards and places each one face up on the stack matching its colour.
7. Each player gains a Keep card to place in their hand



Game Overview

The game is played over **3 rounds**. Each round has a short setup, then **6 turns** of drafting and playing cards, then scoring and a cleanup.

Round structure

1. **Round setup** — deal cards, reveal the Goals, set the Pass token.
2. **Draft Cards**— everyone picks a card to play and a card to store, plays at the same time, then passes their hand.
3. **Round scoring** — add up your face-up paint and any Goal penalties.
4. **Cleanup** — wash each stack down to its top card.

Round setup

1. Deal 7 Paint cards to each player. This is your hand. Place this to the right of your keep card
2. Deal each player 1 Mud card, face down. You may hold up to 3 Mud cards; if you already have 3, you get none. Place all mud cards to the left of your keep card.
3. Reveal the top 2 Goal cards. Both are scored at the end of this round.
4. In Round 1, use the Pass token as it landed during setup. In Rounds 2 and 3, flip it over.

The arrow on the Pass token shows which neighbour you pass cards in the rotational draft and which neighbour receives your **give** abilities this round (these are opposite)

Drafting a card

Each turn has three steps.

1. Choose. Look at your hand of paint cards. Secretly choose:

- One paint card to **play** this turn. Place this face down above all your cards.
- **Optionally,** any mud cards you want to play with this card. Place this also face down with your played card.
- One paint card to **keep** for future turns. Place this card to the left of your “Keep” card along with all your mud cards you haven’t played.

When you only have 1 card left in your hand, discard the card instead of keeping it. It will mean all players draft 6 cards each round.

2. Reveal and play. Everyone reveals their chosen paint card at the same time (and potentially mud card).

1. may use any number of Mud cards (see below),
2. places their card on top of the stack matching its colour, and
3. resolves the card's ability.

Abilities that **give** cards to a neighbour wait until every player has placed their card. Then all give abilities resolve, so gifted cards land on top of what the receiver just played.

3. Pass. Pass all cards right of the your keep card in your hand, to the neighbour in the direction of the Pass token. Take your kept paint card and add it to the rest of your paint cards.

Your stacks

You have four stacks: red, blue, green and yellow.

- A paint card always goes on top of the stack of its matching colour card.
- **Purple** cards are wild: place them on any stack. They have no ability.

- Only the **top card** of a stack is the latest card played in that stack.
- Cards can end up on a stack of a different colour (by moving them, or with Mud). They stay there and count as part of that stack.

Gaining and giving cards (from abilities)

No mud cards can be used in this step.

- **Gain a Splat / Big Splat card:** draw from that deck and place it face up on your stack of the matching colour
- **Give your neighbour a Splat / Big Splat card:** draw from that deck and place it on the matching stack of the neighbour the Pass token points to.
- **Gain / give a Mud card:** draw a Mud card into your hand (or your neighbour's). A player already holding 3 Mud cards gets nothing.

If a deck runs out, shuffle its discard pile to make a new deck.

Flipped and destroyed cards

- A **flipped** (face-down) card is worth 0 and has no ability. It stays in the same place until destroyed and keeps is used for goal scoring.
- A **destroyed** card goes face up onto its own discard pile (Paint, Splat or Big Splat in the middle of the table).

Mud cards

Mud cards are tricks you use just before placing your card. You can use as many as you like on one play, one after another. Used Mud cards are discarded. Each type is listed in the Appendix.

Round scoring

At the end of turn 6, each player scores:

Paint points — add the values of every face-up card in all four of your stacks. Negative cards reduce your total. Flipped cards score 0.

Goal penalties — for each of the 2 Goal cards, compare counts between players. The players with the most take penalty points:

Players	Most	2nd most	3rd most
2	+5	—	—
3	+10	+5	—
4–5	+15	+10	+5

- **Ties:** tied players all take the higher penalty, and the next place is skipped. For example, if two players tie for most at 4 players, both take +15, and the next player takes +5.
- **Zero is safe:** a player with a count of 0 never takes a Goal penalty.

Add your paint points and Goal penalties together and record the total on the scoreboard.

Cleanup

1. Each stack is **washed** down to its top card. Discard everything underneath to the matching discard piles with the top card staying.
2. Keep any mud cards still in your hand.
3. Discard the Goal cards.

End Game

The game ends after Round 3 has been scored. Skip the Round 3 cleanup.

1. Each player loses **2 points for every unused Mud card** still in their hand.
2. **The lowest total wins.** The cleanest player on the field is the champion.

If players are tied, they share the victory.

Appendix: Cards

Paint cards

Each colour (red, blue, green, yellow) has one copy of every value below. "This stack" means the stack the card was just placed on.

Value	Ability
−5	Gain 2 Splat cards.
−4	Gain a Big Splat card.
−3	Give your neighbour a Mud card.
−2	Gain a Splat card.
−1	Gain a Splat card.
0	Move the top card of one of your stacks onto another of your stacks.
1	Rearrange the cards in this stack in any order (this card included).
2	Give your neighbour a Splat card.
3	Gain a Mud card.
4	Give your neighbour a Big Splat card.
5	Give your neighbour 2 Splat cards.
6	Flip the top card of up to 2 of your other stacks face down. Cards already face down cannot be chosen.
7	Gain 2 Mud cards.
8	Destroy up to 3 Splat, Big Splat or face-down cards from anywhere in your stacks.
9	Destroy the 2 cards directly under this card.
10	Destroy the top card of up to 2 of your other stacks.

Purple (wild) cards

Value	Copies	Ability
2	3	None. Place on any stack.
3	3	None. Place on any stack.
4	3	None. Place on any stack.

A purple card breaks up a single-coloured stack.

Splat and Big Splat cards

Splat cards (1–3) and Big Splat cards (4–5) have no ability. They only arrive through other cards' abilities and always go on the stack of their own colour.

Mud cards

Use any number before placing your card that turn.

Mud card	Effect
Rearrange	Rearrange the cards in one of your stacks before playing.
Play anywhere	Place your card on any stack instead of its own colour.
Use the card under	Place your card, but resolve the ability of the card it covers instead of its own. If that card has no ability, nothing happens.
Face down	Place your card face down on any stack. It scores 0 and its ability does not resolve.
Move 2	Before playing, move a top card from one stack to another, twice.

Goal cards

Two are revealed each round. Players with the highest count take the Goal penalties (see Round scoring).

Goal	What you count
Most Red	Cards in your red stack
Most Blue	Cards in your blue stack
Most Green	Cards in your green stack
Most Yellow	Cards in your yellow stack
Most single-coloured stacks	Stacks where every card is the same colour
Most Splat and face-down cards	Splat, Big Splat and face-down cards in all your stacks
Most big stacks	Stacks with 3 or more cards

Colour Goals count every card in that stack, including face-down cards and cards of other colours.